



Five Aspects of Man (2nd Ed.)

Panel 1: How to See What the Bible Is Doing

TEACHING CARD

God's Word.
Five Aspects.
A Complete View
of Man.

1 THE INTRODUCTION

What is an Aspect?

An aspect is a way of viewing man from a certain biblical vantage point. In *Five Aspects of Man*, each aspect is a perspective on man's nature as a masculine creature—not five different types of men. Rather, they are five truths about every man, because God created men to be male.

The five aspects are not competing views, but complementary truths. All the views are important, because if we leave some out, we have a smaller, less accurate picture of what it means to be a man.



Key Idea

God is the Creator of man and woman, and where He speaks about their nature, we have a definite and dependable word.

3 TYPES OF BIBLICAL LITERATURE

The Bible contains different literary forms. Recognizing the genre helps us read each passage according to the way it was written and understand what the author intended to communicate.

	Law	Commands, instructions, and case laws. Tells us what God requires and reveals His holiness.
	Narrative	Accounts of real people and events. Shows what happened, giving examples and patterns.
	Wisdom/Poetry	Uses poetry, figurative language, and proverbs to teach truths about God, life, and human behavior.
	Epistle/Instruction	Letters that teach, correct, and give practical instruction for faithful living.
	Prophecy	Messages from God, often using symbolic language, that call for repentance and reveal His plans.

Why it matters: The genre affects how we interpret a passage. We should always read the Bible according to the way it was written.

5 BIBLICAL NARRATIVES

Biblical narratives communicate truth through real people, events, conflict, consequences, patterns, and God's actions in history. They show us how God works in the real world.

	Narratives describe what happened.
	They give examples, show consequences, and reveal patterns in human experience.
	Narratives do not automatically prescribe what we should do.
	Just because something is described in the Bible does not mean it is commanded or approved. We must interpret narratives in light of the whole counsel of Scripture.

2 THE FIVE ASPECTS

The five aspects are drawn from five key Bible passages, selected to organize the Bible's teaching about masculinity. Each passage gives a basic truth about males and females and how they relate.

Passage	Male Aspect	Female Aspect
Genesis 1	Lord of the Earth	Mistress of the Domain
Genesis 2	Husbandman	Helper-Completer
Genesis 3	Savior	Lifegiver
Proverbs 1–9	Sage	Lady Wisdom
1 Corinthians 11:7 (also Ephesians 5)	Glory of God	Glory of Man

4 LAWS OF SCRIPTURE

The biblical laws are not random rules. They reveal God's holiness, order human life, and show us how to live under His authority. They must be understood in their biblical and covenantal setting.

- **Reveal God's character.**
The laws show that God is holy, just, and good.
- **Guide human life.**
They give structure for a righteous and flourishing society.
- **Teach moral truth.**
They show what is right and wrong and reflect God's eternal standards.
- **Expose sin.**
By showing God's requirements, the law reveals our need for a Savior.
- **Train God's people.**
They instruct and shape God's people to live faithfully.
- **Must be read in context.**
The laws are given within specific covenants (e.g., Mosaic Covenant) and must be understood in their historical and redemptive setting, including their fulfillment in Christ.

6 BASIC BIBLICAL ARCHETYPES

Scripture uses recurring patterns and character types that help us see larger themes and understand how God's story unfolds.

	Seed of the woman vs. seed of the serpent The ongoing conflict between good and evil.		Faithful ruler vs. tyrant Righteous leadership versus self-exalting, destructive rule.
	Wise vs. foolish Two ways of living, with lasting consequences.		Helper-deliverer God raises up deliverers to rescue His people.
	Exile and return Sin brings exile; God brings restoration.		Bride and bridegroom A picture of God's covenant love.
	Sacrifice and redemption Sin requires a sacrifice; God provides redemption in Christ.		

7 THE CREATED, FALLEN, REDEEMED PARADIGM

Each of the five aspects is examined three times—created, fallen, and redeemed. This gives us fifteen views of man (5 aspects × 3 conditions).

	CREATED How God intended it to be originally.		FALLEN How sin and the curse have affected it.		REDEEMED What God has done and is doing to restore it in Christ.
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THE BIG PICTURE

God's Word gives us a complete, reliable view of man. The five aspects are complementary, not competing. Each aspect matters. Together they present the full picture of what it means to be a man.

"So we may present every man
complete in Christ."
Colossians 1:28

Panel 1 of 2



Five Aspects of Man (2nd Ed.)

Panel 2: How Clearer Seeing Changes How We Read

TEACHING CARD

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8 THE BENEFITS OF SEEING MORE CLEARLY

Recognizing literary form, context, covenant setting, and recurring biblical patterns helps us read the Bible more accurately. It keeps us from misinterpreting the text and gives us a clearer, fuller picture of what God is saying.



Avoid confusion.

We are less likely to take a descriptive passage as a command or miss what the author intended.



Distinguish description from prescription.

We can see what a passage is describing, what it is commanding, and what it is illustrating.



See how passages fit in the whole Bible.

Each text makes more sense when we understand its place in God's larger story.



Understand what a text is doing.

We ask what the passage is meant to do before asking how to apply it to our lives.



Gain a fuller, more reliable picture.

We see a more accurate view of man and woman under God, shaped by all of Scripture, not just a few verses.

9 THE FIRST AND SECOND GREAT COMMANDMENTS

All faithful biblical reading should lead to greater love for God and love for neighbor. These two commands summarize the whole law and give direction for how we understand and live out what the Bible teaches about man.



Love the Lord your God.

"You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength." (Mark 12:30)



Love your neighbor as yourself.

"You shall love your neighbor as yourself." (Mark 12:31)

These two great commandments give a moral framework for reading human life. They shape how we understand vocation, relationships, authority, service, justice, and obedience. Every aspect of man—what we are, what we do, and how we relate to others—must be read in the light of love for God and love for neighbor.

10 CREATOR-CREATION DISTINCTION

God alone is Creator. He is self-existent, sovereign, holy, wise, and worthy of worship. Everything else—including man and woman—is created and accountable to Him.



God is the Creator.

He exists in and of Himself (self-existent), rules over all (sovereign), is perfectly holy, perfectly wise, and is worthy of all worship.



Everything else is created.

The world, all life, and all people are created by God, depend on Him, and are accountable to Him.



Man and woman are creatures, not autonomous.

We are not self-defining. Our nature, purpose, and limits are given by our Creator, not determined by our own preferences or by the surrounding culture.



Key Truth

We are God's creatures. We find our true identity, meaning, and flourishing in Him, not in ourselves.

11 PRACTICAL IMPLICATIONS FOR READING

Here are key principles to help us read the Bible more faithfully and apply it wisely.

- 1 Ask what kind of text this is.**
Identify the literary form (law, narrative, poetry, etc.) and read it accordingly.
- 2 Read it in context.**
Consider the immediate context, the whole book, and the place in God's redemptive story.
- 3 Let Scripture interpret Scripture.**
Use the clearer passages of the Bible to help us understand the more difficult ones.
- 4 Distinguish description from what the text commands.**
Not everything in the Bible is a direct instruction for us.
- 5 Pay attention to covenant and redemptive setting.**
Consider where the passage fits in God's unfolding plan.
- 6 Notice recurring biblical patterns.**
Look for the consistent way God presents human nature, sin, redemption, and life under His rule.
- 7 Read man in relation to God's design, not modern assumptions.**
Let the Bible shape our understanding of what it means to be male and female, rather than adopting the views of our culture.

12 SEEING MAN MORE CLEARLY

The five aspects are complementary, not competing. Each highlights a real truth about man, and together they give us a fuller, more balanced picture of what it means to be a man or a woman under God. When we read with these distinctions, we see man more clearly—as God's creature, called to live in His world, for His glory.

Passage	Male Aspect	Female Aspect
Genesis 1	Lord of the Earth	Mistress of the Domain
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1 Corinthians 11:7 (also Ephesians 5)	Glory of God	Glory of Man

13 ONE-SENTENCE TAKEAWAY



The more clearly we see
how Scripture speaks,
the more faithfully we can
understand God's design
and live as His creatures.



THE BIG PICTURE

Clear seeing leads to faithful reading. Faithful reading leads to faithful living.

"You shall love the Lord your God ...
and your neighbor as yourself."
Matthew 22:37–39

Panel 2 of 2